

DEMYSTIFYING MILLIONAIRES

When I was a kid, I didn't really understand what a millionaire was—I just knew I wasn't one. When I saw a famous actor or athlete, I'd think, *That guy's a millionaire. He can do anything.* I thought millionaires had it made. If they saw something they wanted, they could have it without a second thought. It's like they had a magic wand that shot out dollar bills and made all their dreams come true. They lived on Easy Street, and that was a million miles away from my little house on Simmons Street. As a young boy, it never occurred to me that I could have what they had. A million dollars might as well have been a made-up amount to my twelve-year-old brain. That kind of wealth seemed completely unattainable. It wasn't until much later that I finally learned what a millionaire really was. Once I figured that out, it took a lot of the magic and mystery out of the word. At that point, *millionaire* became less of a dream and more of a goal.